

people or distribution list', which is also the most obvious rule. Similar steps ensue for any of the rules in the top box—for example, with specific words in the subject, and so on.

When you checkmark 'from people or distribution list', the second box shows up 'Apply this rule after the message arrives from people or distribution list'. Here, 'people or distribution list' is hyperlinked. Click the hyperlink, and you'll get an address list. From the address list, you can specify what people's messages you want this rule to apply to.

This sets up what kinds of messages to catch with this specific rule. The next logical step is what action should be taken with the messages that are caught with the rule. You can choose to move it to a particular folder, to automatically delete the message, automatically forward it to someone, and so on.

Since we're now organising your folders, let's say you want to move such messages to a particular folder. Simply specify that in the rule—it's easy and intuitive to do so. At this point, you may want to specify exceptions to your rule: say your rule was that all mails from your boss go into the 'Boss' folder. But if the boss is calling a meeting, you want it flagged and in your Inbox. Specify this: tell Outlook the rule applies unless the subject line contains the word 'meeting'. Again, it's easy, with the wizard, to specify exceptions.

Once you're done with specifying your rule, there are a couple of things to take care of. First, you have to name the rule. Second, you choose whether to turn the rule on right now (you can always turn it off whenever you want to). Third, once it's turned on, you choose whether to run the rule right now—in our example, all the messages from your boss will instantly be moved to the 'Boss' folder if you do this. Finally, you choose whether to apply the rule to all the mail accounts you've specified in Outlook, or only to specific accounts.

After you've set up all your rules, you'll find that maintaining your mails and folders gets a whole lot easier.